

KM MODERNIZATION

FROM REPOSITORY TO DECISION-SUPPORT SYSTEM

For a large-scale contact centre

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Scenario: A large-scale loyalty program serving millions of members through retail, travel, dining, and financial-services partners. Knowledge Management sits inside the contact centre, translating fast-changing business rules into the guidance frontline agents rely on to resolve live customer interactions.

- Fragmented Knowledge Management system (KM) slowed real-time decision-making in frontline operations
- Validated UX impact through targeted IA-led restructuring in a high-risk environment
- Led system redesign enabling faster decisions & ~\$100K+ **scalable annual impact**

WHERE KM BREAKS DOWN

- Frontline decision-making happened live, under pressure, and across systems
- KM could not keep pace with the **speed**, **complexity**, and **risk** - breaking down when it mattered most
- It supported access to information, *not action*

HOW IT SHOWS UP IN PRACTICE

OBSERVED FRONTLINE BEHAVIOURS

- Search → guess → backtrack
- Delays during live interactions
- Inconsistent decisions across teams

IMPACT

Confidence in KM declined as a reliable source of truth

PAST EFFORTS ALL FOCUSED ON CONTENT

Access improved, but friction in live workflows persisted.



*Affinity Mapping
(Patterns identified from 100+ frontline observations)*

MY ROLE:

INTRODUCING A NEW APPROACH

Proposed structural change and validated it through an IA-led pilot – *applying UX and IA principles to KM*

- Reframed KM as a performance system
- Introduced task-based navigation aligned to workflows
- Defined a direction for system-level redesign *beyond incremental fixes*

FRAMING THE DIRECTION

A clear direction was established to align user needs with operational realities and guide all system-level decisions.

NORTH STAR

Enable frontline teams to quickly and confidently find the right guidance under pressure.



SUCCESS CRITERIA

- ≤3 clicks to key tasks
- Single source of truth
- Clear, actionable guidance
- Consistent, predictable structure



CONSTRAINTS

- Compliance & auditability
- Accountability & repeatability
- Privacy & data protection
- Safety & risk management
- Platform limitations
- Training & QA dependencies
- Metadata & governance integrity

These criteria defined what “good” looks like and guided every design decision.

PROVING THE APPROACH

BACKOFFICE KM SECTION

A high-risk environment chosen to validate structural change

- Multi-step decisions under pressure
- Speed and accuracy critical
- Cross-system dependencies

**IF IT WORKS
HERE,
IT SCALES**

FROM GUESSWORK TO DIRECT ACCESS

IA-led restructuring simplified how users navigate to actions

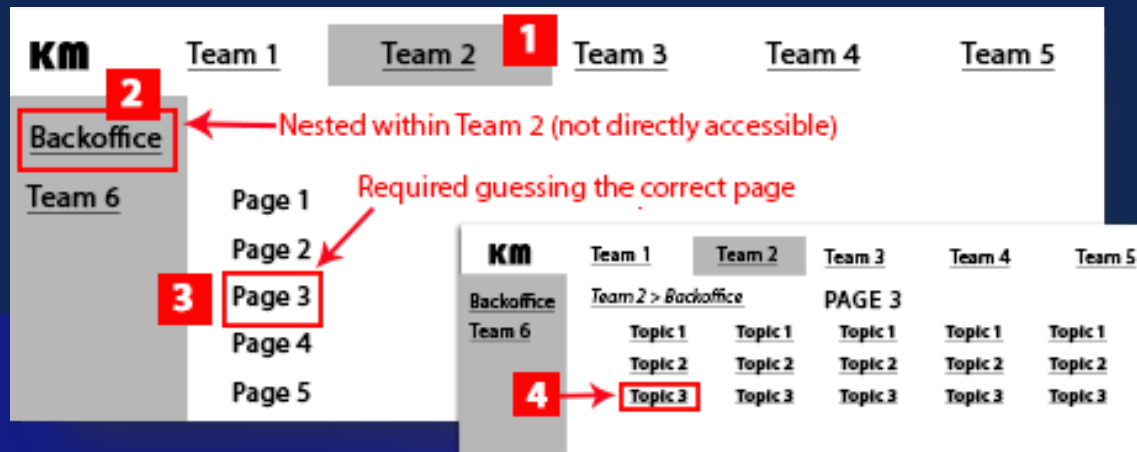
BEFORE

Fragmentation

Guessing

Backtracking

~4.3 CLICKS PER TOPIC
(6 clicks for wrong guesses)



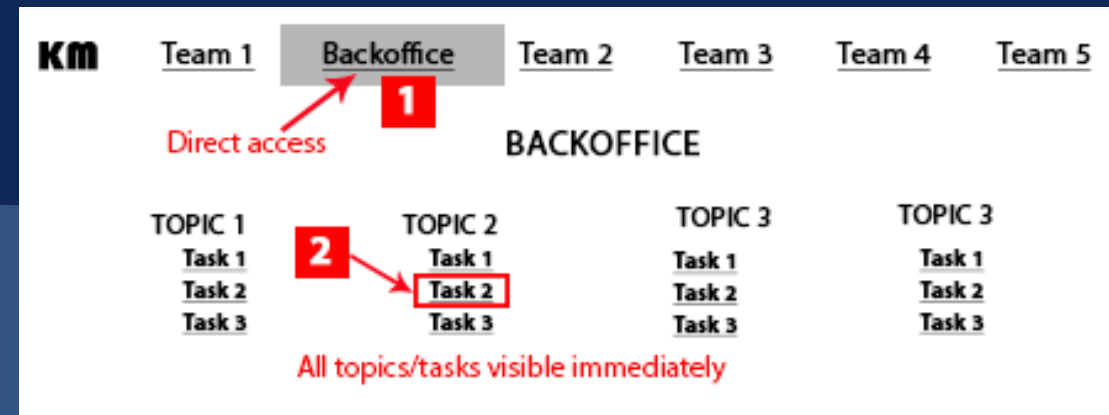
AFTER

Direct access to workflow

Dedicated task-based entry point

All topics visible immediately

Max 2 CLICKS PER TOPIC
(consistent and predictable)



Eliminating guesswork reduced cognitive load and improved decision speed.

OUTSIZED IMPACT

PILOT RESULTS FROM A 16-AGENT TEAM

- ~50 seconds saved per topic
- ~14 minutes saved per agent per day
- ~875+ hours recovered annually
- ~\$17.5K-\$22.5K annual savings

Proved that the core issue was structure - not content



Even a 1-click reduction per topic, scaled across 135 agents, unlocks over \$100K in annual savings

FROM PROOF TO SYSTEM DESIGN

THE PILOT VALIDATED A CLEAR SHIFT

KM must support decisions,
not just content access.

DESIGN PRINCIPLES DERIVED FROM THIS INSIGHT

- Structure aligned to workflows
- Guidance drives action
- Next steps are clear and actionable
- Designed for real-time use under pressure
- Scales consistently across teams

DETERMINING THE RIGHT STRUCTURE

The structure was evaluated based on real user behavior and constraints

OPTIONS EXPLORED

Task-based
Topic-based
Skill-based
System-based

SELECTED APPROACH

Task-based IA
supported by
topic-based
domains

WHY THIS WORKS

Aligns with how users
initiate tasks
Minimizes navigation
under pressure
Supports real-time
decision-making
Scales across teams
and workflows

WHY OTHERS FELL SHORT

Skill-based: siloed;
multi-skilled users forced
to switch contexts
System-based: requires
prior knowledge
Topic-based: lacks action
orientation

THE FINAL STRUCTURE

KM MODERNIZATION IA STRUCTURE

Balancing consistency & relevance without fragmenting navigation

SYSTEM LOGIC

- One consistent task-based navigation
- Role-based access layered within tasks
- Labels aligned to actions, not content

LEGAND

Access Levels	Visibility
General (minimum)	
Specialized (medium)	
Advance (full access)	

Manage Account & Balance

Update Profile

Manage Profile Access

Report Fraud

Investigate & Resolve Fraud

Earn Miles

View Card Offers

View Travel Promotions

View Grocery Offers

Validate Offer Eligibility

Redeem & Manage Rewards

Redeem Merchandise

Book Travel

Modify or Cancel Bookings

Resolve Travel Exceptions

Resolve Program Issues

De-escalation Guidelines

Investigate Missing Miles

Issue Goodwill Miles

Handle Partner Escalations

Troubleshoot System Issues

View Performance Metrics

Account Handling Issues

Travel System Issues

System Escalation Issues

Operational Alerts & Updates

Surfaced globally across the system, ensuring visibility regardless of where users are navigating.

WHAT THIS WORK DEMONSTRATES

Translating UX and IA into measurable business impact
Designing systems aligned to real-world decision-making under pressure
Driving alignment for structural change through proof; not assumption
Building scalable knowledge systems grounded in structure and governance

FROM KNOWLEDGE ACCESS TO DECISION INTELLIGENCE
ENABLED BY METADATA AND BUILT FOR AI AT SCALE

Thank you!
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